

HA BUI

Department of Economics
Grinnell College
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EMPLOYMENT AND AFFILIATIONS

Assistant Professor, Department of Economics, Grinnell College Aug. 2024-Present

Officer - Lecturer, Department of International Economics Sep. 2012-Jun. 2016
Ministry of Foreign Affairs (Vietnam), Diplomatic Academy of Vietnam

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics, The University of Texas at Austin 2024

M.S. in Economics, The University of Texas at Austin 2023

M.A. in Economics, The University of Texas at Austin 2018

B.A. in International Economics (Summa Cum Laude), Diplomatic Academy of Vietnam 2012

WORKING PAPERS

Noisy Global Value Chains (*Revise and Resubmit: Journal of Political Economy*)
NBER Working Paper 30033, with Zhen Huo, Andrei A. Levchenko, and Nitya Pandalai-Nayar

We study international propagation of both fundamental and non-fundamental shocks in a global production network model with information frictions. Producers in a sector do not perfectly observe other country-sector fundamentals, and their production decisions depend on their beliefs about worldwide exogenous states as well as other producers' behavior. In this environment, "noise" shocks – errors in the public signals about fundamentals – propagate internationally and generate aggregate fluctuations. Using a novel panel dataset containing the frequencies of country-industry-specific economic news reports by 11 leading newspapers in the G7 plus Spain, we show that greater news coverage is associated with both smaller GDP forecast errors, and less disagreement among forecasters. We use these empirical regularities to discipline the parameters governing the severity of information frictions. We find that noise shocks are a quantitatively important source of international fluctuations. Noise shocks propagate relatively more powerfully to the more distant parts of the network, while TFP shocks propagate less powerfully to the more distant sectors in the presence of informational frictions.

Inequality in Income and Varieties

This paper studies the impact of local income inequality on household consumption and welfare through the changing availability of varieties of consumer goods. I find that in high-inequality counties, more varieties are offered to households. However, households living in high-inequality counties purchase fewer varieties compared to similar ones in low-inequality counties. This happens even though households shop in more stores in high-inequality counties. These effects are even more pronounced for individuals in the tails of the income distribution. To quantify channels underlying these empirical findings and speak to the welfare impact, I develop a model featuring an endogenous number of varieties produced by firms and a choice over which varieties to purchase by households. After estimating many of the parameters of the model, I show that the model can reproduce both empirical facts. Quantitatively, I find that households are generally worse off when living in higher-inequality regions because firms are better able to segment the market.

Industry News and Firms' Expectations

This paper studies the role of industry news in shaping firms' expectations of macroeconomic conditions. Using a U.S. survey of firms' inflation expectations, Coibion et al. (2020) report a large disagreement among firms about future aggregate conditions even though they observe similar aggregate statistics. Andrade et al. (2020) use a survey of French manufacturing firms and document that the firm's industry conditions play an important role in forming firm's aggregate expectations. However, many small and medium-sized firms are unlikely to have access to privileged industry information. Instead, they rely on standard news sources to learn about industry conditions. Therefore, firms' public industry news would have a substantial role in shaping their view of aggregate economic conditions. Using South African firm-level expectation data together with state-of-the-art Natural Language Processing models on a novel dataset of news reports in major South African newspapers and newspapers of South Africa's major trading partners, this paper provides new evidence documenting the role of firms' industry news on forming their expectations about aggregate macroeconomic condition.

WORK IN PROGRESS

“The Anatomy of Intangible Investment and Firm’s Growth” (with Anushka Mitra and Dongchen Zhao)

“Firm’s Financial Heterogeneity and the Employment Channel of Monetary Policy” (with Natassa Zervou)

“Technology, Workers’ Skill Development, and Firm’s Growth” (with Nitya Pandalai-Nayar)

“The Dynamics of Firms’ Customer Base” (with Dongchen Zhao)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Department of Economics, Grinnell College

Courses taught as Instructor:

Seminar in Macroeconomics

Time Series Econometrics

Macroeconomics Analysis

Fall 2025

Fall 2024, Spring 2025, Fall 2025

Fall 2024, Spring 2025

Department of Economics, University of Texas at Austin

Research Training Workshop: Factiva database & Python	Summer 2025
International Trade, Teaching Assistant for Prof. Nitya Pandalai-Nayar	Spring 2022, Spring 2024
Macroeconomic Theory, Teaching Assistant for Prof. Olivier Coibion	Fall 2022, Fall 2023
Macroeconomic Theory, Teaching Assistant for Prof. Christoph Boehm	Spring 2023
Introduction to Economics, Teaching Assistant for Prof. Dean Showalter	Summer 2022
International Economics (M.A. course), Teaching Assistant for Prof. Shalah Mostashari	Fall 2021
Time Series (M.A. course), Teaching Assistant for Prof. Anastasia Zervou	Spring 2019, Spring 2020
Introduction to Econometrics, Teaching Assistant for Prof. Stephen Donald	Fall 2019
Introduction to Microeconomics, Teaching Assistant for Prof. Helen Schneider	Fall 2018

Diplomatic Academy of Vietnam, Ministry of Foreign Affairs of Vietnam*Courses taught as Instructor:*

International Economics, Macroeconomics, Microeconomics,	2012-2016
International Economic Integration and International Organizations	

OTHER PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Special Sworn Status (SSS) Researcher, U.S. Census Bureau	2021-present
Data Science for All – Women’s Summit, Correlation One	2022
Research Assistant for Prof. Nitya Pandalai-Nayar (UT Austin)	Summer 2022
Web-scraping and Data-cleaning for Research, Kelley School of Business	2021
Research Assistant for Prof. Olivier Coibion (UT Austin), Prof. Andrei A. Levchenko (University of Michigan), and Prof. Nitya Pandalai-Nayar (UT Austin)	2020-2021
Research Assistant for Prof. Saroj Bhattarai (UT Austin)	Fall 2020
Research Assistant for Prof. Olivier Coibion (UT Austin) and Prof. Yuriy Gorodnichenko (UC Berkeley)	2017-2018
Research Assistant for Prof. Sandra Black (UT Austin)	2017-2018
Researcher, Diplomatic Academy of Vietnam, Ministry of Foreign Affairs of Vietnam	2012-2016
Teaching Assistant, Foreign Service Training Center, Ministry of Foreign Affairs	2011-2012
Research Assistant, Institute for Foreign Policy and Strategic Studies, Ministry of Foreign Affairs of Vietnam	2010-2012

AWARDS, HONORS, FELLOWSHIPS AND GRANTS

Competitive Research Grant, Grinnell College (\$5000)	2025
Curricular Development Grant, Instructional Support Committee, Grinnell College (~\$500)	2025
Graduate School Continuing Fellowship, UT Austin	2022-2023
NBER Behavioral Macroeconomics Research Boot Camp for Graduate Students	2022
Stanford Big-Data Initiative in International Macro-Finance, Stanford University	2021
Graduate Summer Fellowship, Department of Economics, UT Austin	2021, 2022
Professional Development Award, UT Austin	2020, 2022, 2023
Best Second Year Paper Award, Department of Economics, UT Austin	2020
Collaborative Research Fellowship, Department of Economics, UT Austin	2020
Fulbright Scholarship	2016-2018

CONFERENCE AND SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

2025:

Seminars/Conferences: AALAC Economic History Conference 2025, 32nd Annual Symposium of the Society for Nonlinear Dynamics and Econometrics, Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting (scheduled), The University of Texas at San Antonio (scheduled)

Discussions: The 2025 Omaha Macroeconomic Forum (scheduled), Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting (scheduled)

2024: Western Economic Association International Conference 2024, Grinnell College, Xiamen University, University of Tokyo, Duke Kunshan University, Louisiana State University, University of Western Australia, University of Bristol, University of Nottingham, Hertie School and the IfW Kiel Seminar Series, Koc University, Bilkent University, College of the Holy Cross.

2023: Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting, Midwest Macro Fall 2023 Meeting, National Taipei University, Shanghai University of Finance and Economics - School of Economics

2022: Midwest Macro Fall 2022 Meeting

2021: Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting

SERVICE

To the Profession

Referee: The Review of Economics and Statistics, Review of International Economics, Journal of International Financial Markets, Institutions & Money

Panelist for the Career Workshop, Society of Women in Economics, UT Austin May 2025

To Grinnell College

Institutional Review Board (IRB), Grinnell College Fall 2025-Present

Grinnell College, Department of Economics Monthly Economics Workshops Fall 2024-Present

Grinnell College, Department of Economics Senior Dinner Spring 2025-Present

Mentoring Student Research Assistants: Hanmo (Linda) Jing (2026), Sungjin (Paul) Lim (2027)

SKILLS

Programs: MATLAB, Python, R, Stata

Languages: English (Fluent), Vietnamese (Native)

Last updated: September 2025